



SUBJECT	IAF Air Intelligence Overview — Multi-Domain Briefing	REPORT TYPE	Research Summary
GENERATED	15 Jul 2026, 05:46 UTC	HANDLING	RESTRICTED — For Official Use
SOURCES	521 content items	CONFIDENCE	78%

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IAF Air Intelligence Overview — Multi-Domain Briefing

521 CONTENT ITEMS	16 SOURCES	11 CLUSTERS	3315 SIGNALS
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BOTTOM-LINE JUDGEMENT

Automated monitoring of 521 content items from 16 sources across defence publications, OSINT channels, adversary media, and social platforms reveals 11 narrative clusters and 3,315 intelligence signals across three domains: Chinese Air Power (LAC threat assessment), Anti-IAF Disinformation (deepfake detection), and PAF Modernization (force posture). Key findings: J-20 stealth deployment confirmed at Hotan and Kashgar by 5 independent sources; coordinated deepfake campaign against IAF detected across 4 platforms with 0.94 probability score; Tibet airbase infrastructure expansion tracked via satellite OSINT; aircraft serial tracked across 3 independent sources demonstrating automated movement correlation. All processing sovereign — zero cloud dependency. Collection period: 12 Jan 2026 to 14 Jul 2026.

PART I • DATA SHEET

Source Inventory

SOURCE	PLATFORM	CREDIBILITY	ITEMS
Bellingcat OSINT	web	85	172
The War Zone	rss	80	136
Indian Defence Review	rss	76	125
LiveFist Defence	rss	74	36
SIPRI Arms Transfers	web	88	16
Defence OSINT	telegram	55	6
Air Power India	telegram	45	5
Jane's Defence Weekly	rss	91	4

China Mil Watch	telegram	48	4
Defence Forum India	reddit	35	3
Defence.pk Forum	web	40	3
IAF Disinfo Alert	telegram	50	3
Global Times Military	web	35	2
Military Aviation IG	instagram	52	2
PAF Tracker	telegram	42	2
SCMP Defence	rss	72	2

Narrative Clusters

CLUSTER	ITEMS	INDEP. SOURCES	SUMMARY
J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC	12	5	Multiple independent sources confirm J-20 fifth-generation stealth fighter deplo
Coordinated Deepfake Campaign Against IAF	10	4	Coordinated disinformation operation detected across Telegram, Reddit, Instagram
PLAAF UAV/Drone Activity — Northern Borders	8	4	Rising PLAAF drone activity along LAC. WZ-7 Soaring Dragon high-altitude ISR UAV
Tibet Airbase Infrastructure Expansion	8	4	Rapid infrastructure expansion across Tibetan plateau airbases. New 3,500m runwa
JF-17 Block 3 Induction & PAF-PLAAF Exercises	10	3	PAF inducts JF-17 Block 3 with KLJ-7A AESA radar and PL-15 BVR missile integrati
HAL/DRDO Misinformation Narratives	7	3	Adversary media weaponizing Tejas production delay narratives and spreading fals

Top Entities

ENTITY	TYPE	MENTIONS
Bellingcat	ORG	459
India	GPE	406
China	GPE	164
Iaf	ORG	114
Amca	ORG	68
Pakistan	GPE	62
Click ‘Cookie	ORG	53

Stockholm International Peace Research Institute Sipri	ORG	53
Brahmos	ORG	36
Latin America & Caribbean	ORG	31
Donald Trump	PERSON	31
Macuto	ORG	30

Trending Keywords

- LAC (298)
- stealth (62)
- J-20 (21)
- PLAAF (16)
- fifth-gen (16)
- Hotan (7)
- Kashgar (5)
- Ngari (5)
- Wing Loong (4)
- WZ-7 (3)
- Tibet airbase (3)
- Aksai Chin (2)
- WS-15 (2)

Language Breakdown

LANGUAGE	ITEMS
English	521

Signals, Identifiers & Patterns

Active Signals

SIGNAL	CLUSTER	STATUS	DATE
Telegram handle @fake_iaf_leaks identified across 4 independent sources as coordinated amplification node for anti-IAF d	—	new	2026-06-19
Coordinated deepfake campaign detected across 4 platforms — Telegram, Reddit, Instagram, web. @fake_iaf_leaks identified	—	new	2026-06-17
Tibet airbase infrastructure expansion confirmed across 4 independent sources — Bellingcat, Jane's, @china_mil_watch, SC	—	new	2026-06-15
PAF JF-17 Block 3 induction confirmed by Jane's, SIPRI, and @paf_tracker with corroborating AESA radar specifications	—	new	2026-06-13
J-20 deployment near LAC confirmed by 5 independent sources (Jane's, SCMP, Bellingcat, @china_mil_watch, @defence_osint)	—	new	2026-06-09
Identifier AIRCRAFT_ID 'J-20 serial 78271' found across 3 independent sources	AIRCRAFT_ID: J-20 serial 78271	new	2026-07-15
Identifier TELEGRAM_HANDLE 'fake_iaf_leaks' found across 4 independent sources	TELEGRAM_HANDLE: fake_iaf_leaks	new	2026-07-15

Identified Indicators

TYPE	VALUE	SOURCES	ITEMS
TELEGRAM_HANDLE	fake_iaf_leaks	4	6
AIRCRAFT_ID	J-20 serial 78271	3	3
TELEGRAM_HANDLE	china_mil_watch	1	5

Content Item Records

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

Defence OSINT · telegram · 2026-06-15 · Credibility: 55

Defence OSINT assesses J-20 unit at Hotan has achieved 24/7 alert readiness based on hangar door open/close patterns over 14 days. Minimum 2 aircraft on hot standby at all times. Unprecedented for PLAAF fifth-gen operations near India.

https://t.me/defence_osint/460

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

China Mil Watch · telegram · 2026-06-13 · Credibility: 48

Two-ship J-20 formation photographed by civilian pilot near Aksai Chin. Aircraft at estimated FL450. Clean configuration — no external stores. Serial 78271 and 78273 identified from enhanced imagery.

https://t.me/china_mil_watch/910

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

LiveFist Defence · rss · 2026-06-11 · Credibility: 74

LiveFist Defence: Thermal imagery from commercial satellites shows J-20 night operations at Hotan. At least 4 sorties between 2200-0400 local time. Night operations capability indicates advanced pilot training and platform maturity.

<https://www.livefistdefence.com/j20-night-ops>

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

Indian Defence Review · rss · 2026-06-09 · Credibility: 76

Indian Defence Review assessment: J-20 deployment at Hotan and Kashgar fundamentally alters air balance along LAC. India must accelerate AMCA timeline and consider additional Rafale squadrons. Current Su-30MKI radar cross-section disadvantage significant.

<https://www.indiandefencereview.com/j20-lac-implications>

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

Air Power India · telegram · 2026-06-08 · Credibility: 45

Air Power India analysis: J-20 with WS-15 closes the supercruise gap with Rafale. Key advantages: larger weapons bay, higher service ceiling. Rafale maintains edge in EW suite and proven combat record. LAC theatre favors stealth at altitude.

https://t.me/airpower_india/234

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

Bellingcat OSINT · web · 2026-06-07 · Credibility: 85

Bellingcat geospatial analysis traces J-20 shelter construction at Hotan from March 2025. Planet Labs imagery shows 12 hardened shelters, taxiway extensions, and new fuel storage. Facility designed for sustained operations with 16+ aircraft capacity.

<https://www.bellingcat.com/j20-hotan-analysis>

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

Global Times Military · web · 2026-06-06 · Credibility: 35

Global Times editorial: J-20 deployment near western border is legitimate self-defence measure in response to Indian provocations at LAC. PLAAF modernization is peaceful and defensive in nature. Western media exaggerating threat.

<https://www.globaltimes.cn/page/j20-western-deployment>

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

The War Zone · rss · 2026-06-05 · Credibility: 80

The War Zone analysis: WS-15 turbofan engine now confirmed on production J-20B variants. Engine delivers 18 tonnes thrust with supercruise capability. Combat radius extends to 2,200 km from Hotan — covering all of northern Ladakh and Kashmir valley without aerial refuelling.

<https://www.twz.com/j20-ws15-engine-upgrade>

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

Defence OSINT · telegram · 2026-06-04 · Credibility: 55

Defence OSINT: Multiple J-20 sorties detected in Aksai Chin corridor over 48 hours. Flight patterns suggest air superiority training with simulated BVR engagements. PLAAF using new datalink for coordinated stealth ops. Serial 78271 confirmed again.

https://t.me/defence_osint/445

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

China Mil Watch · telegram · 2026-06-03 · Credibility: 48

BREAKING: New satellite pass shows 4x J-20 at Kashgar forward operating base. Previously only seen at Hotan. Two aircraft appear to have external fuel tanks fitted — suggests extended range ops towards Ladakh sector. Serial 78271 visible on tail.

https://t.me/china_mil_watch/892

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

SCMP Defence · rss · 2026-06-02 · Credibility: 72

South China Morning Post reports PLAAF Western Theatre Command has achieved initial operational capability with J-20 stealth fighters at two forward bases near India border. Sources indicate integration of new PL-15 beyond-visual-range missiles enhancing engagement envelope.

<https://www.scmp.com/news/china/military/j20-operational>

J-20 Stealth Fighter Deployments near LAC

Jane's Defence Weekly · rss · 2026-06-01 · Credibility: 91

Jane's Defence confirms deployment of at least eight J-20 fifth-generation stealth fighters at Hotan Airbase, Xinjiang Province. Satellite imagery from commercial providers shows new hardened aircraft shelters constructed specifically for the platform. Deployment represents significant force project...

<https://www.janes.com/defence-news/j20-hotan-deployment>

Tibet Airbase Infrastructure Expansion

Indian Defence Review · rss · 2026-06-24 · Credibility: 76

Indian Defence Review: Tibet airbase buildup fundamentally changes India strategic calculus on LAC. Forward basing reduces PLAAF transit time, increases sortie generation rate, and enables sustained operations previously impossible at altitude.

<https://www.indiandefencereview.com/tibet-infrastructure>

Coordinated Deepfake Campaign Against IAF

Defence Forum India · reddit · 2026-06-22 · Credibility: 35

Defence Forum India OSINT thread traces @fake_iaf_leaks Telegram channel creation to IP range associated with known state-sponsored influence operations. Channel registered 72h before first deepfake dropped. Pattern matches previous campaigns.

https://reddit.com/r/IndianDefence/disinfo_analysis

Coordinated Deepfake Campaign Against IAF

IAF Disinfo Alert · telegram · 2026-06-21 · Credibility: 50

@fake_iaf_leaks channel still active despite reports. New content appearing — now targeting HAL production delays. Same amplification network pushing narratives across platforms. Channel admin uses VPN, registration via +852 Hong Kong number.

https://t.me/iaf_disinfo_alert/85

Tibet Airbase Infrastructure Expansion

LiveFist Defence · rss · 2026-06-21 · Credibility: 74

LiveFist: Comprehensive timeline of 5 Tibet airbase upgrades from 2024-2026. Ngari Gunsa (runway), Lhasa Gonggar (shelters), Shigatse (fuel/ammo), Bangda (apron expansion), Kashgar (drone hangars). Combined capacity: 150+ combat aircraft.

<https://www.livefistdefence.com/tibet-base-timeline>

Coordinated Deepfake Campaign Against IAF

LiveFist Defence · rss · 2026-06-20 · Credibility: 74

LiveFist: IAF Public Relations Directorate issues official statement debunking Rafale and Tejas deepfake videos. Provides original source footage comparison. Urges media to verify before sharing. CERT-In notified for takedown.

<https://www.livefistdefence.com/iaf-counters-deepfake>

Coordinated Deepfake Campaign Against IAF

The War Zone · rss · 2026-06-19 · Credibility: 80

The War Zone reports on the coordinated deepfake campaign targeting Indian Air Force. Analysis shows professional-grade AI generation tools used. Campaign timing coincides with Aero India 2026 preparations. Likely state-sponsored information operation.

<https://www.twz.com/iaf-deepfake-campaign>

PLAAF UAV/Drone Activity — Northern Borders

Indian Defence Review · rss · 2026-06-19 · Credibility: 76

Indian Defence Review strategic assessment: PLAAF drone buildup represents most significant asymmetric threat shift at LAC since 2020. Recommends fast-tracking Tapas and Archer programs, and Heron TP acquisition for armed ISR.

<https://www.indiandefencereview.com/drone-threat-lac>

Coordinated Deepfake Campaign Against IAF

Air Power India · telegram · 2026-06-18 · Credibility: 45

New deepfake: fabricated HAL Tejas crash video using footage from Ukraine Su-25 incident. @fake_iaf_leaks channel posts within hours of Rafale video. Same temporal artifacts — likely same AI tool used for generation.

https://t.me/airpower_india/245

Sourcing, Limitations & Confidence

Data Acquisition

Automated open-source collection via Anveshak platform. Sources configured by analyst — web scraping (Crawl4AI), social media adapters (Telegram, Reddit, Bluesky, X), and RSS feeds.

Analysis Period

521 content items from 16 sources, processed through multilingual NLP (spaCy + NLLB-200), narrative clustering (Leiden algorithm), and entity extraction.

Confidence Calibration

Confidence level (78%) reflects the fraction of narrative clusters corroborated by 2+ independent sources. Individual source credibility scores are auto-adjusted based on deepfake detection, contradiction analysis, and analyst feedback.

Limitations

This report is a point-in-time snapshot. Source credibility scores may have changed since generation. All AI-generated summaries require analyst verification. Legal provision mappings (if present) are AI-generated and require verification by a qualified legal officer.